DNS Tool

Communication Standards — Clarity & Vision Quality Gate

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PROJECT dnstool.it-help.tech SOURCE github.com/careyjames/dns-tool-web

VERSION 26.37.35 · LICENSE BUSL-1.1

Companion to Founder's Manifesto and Philosophical Foundations

1. Dual-Gate Requirement

Every piece of user-facing text must pass **both** gates simultaneously. Passing one gate but failing the other is a failure.

Gate 1: Clarity

The words chosen must be clear, communicative, and logical to the reader. Text should educate, not obscure.

REQUIREMENT	LEVEL	MEASUREMENT
Jargon with first use	MUST	Every acronym expanded on first use per page, or linked
Active voice	SHOULD	Prefer "The SPF record authorizes..." over passive
Sentence length	SHOULD	Body copy sentences should not exceed 35 words
One idea per paragraph	SHOULD	Each paragraph should advance one concept
Action-oriented findings	MUST	State what was observed, why it matters, what to do

RFC citation	MUST	Claims about protocol behavior must cite specific RFC section
Transformative language	SHOULD	Prefer language that teaches rather than restates

Gate 2: Vision

The visual presentation must not cause strain or impede comprehension. The reader's eyes matter.

REQUIREMENT	LEVEL	MEASUREMENT
Minimum font size	MUST	No rendered text below 0.75rem (12px)
Body text minimum	SHOULD	Primary reading text at least 0.875rem (14px)
Contrast ratio (normal text)	MUST	WCAG 2.1 AA: minimum 4.5:1 against background
Contrast ratio (large text)	MUST	WCAG 2.1 AA: minimum 3:1 for 18px+ or 14px+ bold
Text overflow	MUST	No text beyond container boundary
Line length	SHOULD	Body text ≤ 80 characters per line
Line height	SHOULD	Body text at least 1.5 line-height
Scotopic mode	MUST	Minimum 4.5:1 contrast against covert background (#0a0c10)
Focus indicators	MUST	Visible focus indicators on all interactive elements

2. Audience Calibration

DNS Tool serves three primary audiences with different reading contexts:

The Engineer

Context: Analyzing a domain at a terminal, possibly at 2 AM, under incident pressure.
Needs: Precision, RFC references, verification commands, machine-parseable output.
Vision concern: Extended reading sessions on dark backgrounds. Font size and contrast directly affect error rate.

The Executive

Context: Reading a brief before a board meeting or vendor assessment.
Needs: Risk posture in business terms, remediation cost/complexity, decision points.
Vision concern: May be reading on phone, tablet, or printed page. Layout must be responsive.

The Older Professional

Context: 20+ years in infosec, may have age-related vision changes (presbyopia, reduced contrast sensitivity).
Needs: Everything both audiences need, plus accommodation for reduced visual acuity.
Vision concern: This is the primary reason the font-size floor exists. 10px text that “looks fine” to a 25-year-old developer may be unreadable to the 55-year-old CISO.

3. Enforcement

Automated Checks

CHECK	TOOL	THRESHOLD
Font size floor	CSS audit	Zero sub-0.75rem values
Contrast ratio	squirrelscan	Zero errors

Text overflow	Manual viewport testing	No horizontal scrollbar at 375px, 768px, 1024px, 1440px
Heading hierarchy	squirrelscan	No skipped levels
Lighthouse accessibility	Chrome Lighthouse	Score ≥ 95

Manual Review Checklist

- [ ] CLARITY Can a non-technical executive understand the main finding within 10 seconds?
- [ ] CLARITY Does every acronym have a first-use expansion or link?
- [ ] CLARITY Does every security finding include a “what to do” action?
- [ ] VISION At 50cm / 20″, can all text be read on a 13″ laptop at 100% zoom?
- [ ] VISION In scotopic mode, does all text pass WCAG AA contrast (4.5:1)?
- [ ] VISION On a 375px mobile viewport, does all content fit without horizontal scroll?
- [ ] VISION Are interactive elements large enough for touch targets (44×44px)?

4. CSS Reference Values

Enforced values as of v26.37.35:

PROPERTY	VALUE	CONTRAST RATIO	STANDARD
Font size floor	`0.75rem` (12px)	—	All `.u-fs-*` utility classes enforce this minimum
`.text-muted`	`#9ca3af` on `#0d1117`	~7.45:1	WCAG AA (requires 4.5:1)
`.card.bg-dark .text-muted`	`#adb5bd` on `#21262d`	~8.8:1	WCAG AA
Secondary text minimum	`#8b949e` on `#0d1117`	~6.15:1	Replaces prior `#6c757d` (~4.04:1)

5. Connection to Project Philosophy

[ACCOUNTABILITY] — If the text is unreadable, the finding is unaccountable: it exists but cannot be acted upon.

[ZERO_WASTE] — Text that cannot be read is wasted: it consumes space without delivering value.

[VERBOSE+++++] — Clarity does not mean brevity. It means every word earns its place by advancing the reader's understanding.

Vision as Ethics — Causing eye strain to a reader who came for security intelligence is a design failure with real consequences.

"A score without a citation is an opinion. A finding without readability is invisible."

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